

# Episode 2 — The Ferryman

*Echoes of Havenbay · full script draft*

*v3 (canon-revised for the Listener-first season) · 12 July 2026*

*Echoes of Havenbay · v3 (canon-revised for the Listener-first season) 2026-07-12 · conforms to episode-writers-prompt.md v2*

## Logline

In 2006, the night ferryman Danny Reyes rowed Havenbay harbour's last crossing and never came back; the file said accident, the town said thief, and his daughter spent twenty years knowing both were lies. Ally proves it was murder — and discovers the money route Danny died carrying still runs on the same tide, watched by someone who has been collecting her family for twenty years.

**The victim:** Danny Reyes — and Rosa Reyes, 39, who runs the Harbor Ward fuel dock and has kept her father's logbook since she was nineteen.

**The secret:** Danny was the harbour's bagman — “the ferryman” was a job before it was a name. Every Thursday for eleven years he rowed unbanked cash from Pier 13 across the water. In his final month he began keeping a parallel ledger because he wanted out: he was going to trade it to a journalist. The journalist was Thomas Quinn. Danny disappeared four days before the meet. Dock foreman “Sailor” Merrick (d. 2011) drove the skiff out and wrote Danny's final logbook entry himself — and a coin was left taped to the tiller. The route never stopped. Its current operator — the Ferryman — knows exactly who Ally is.

**The reveal ladder:** 1. The Gazette itself carried the “thief” smear — and Arthur finds the 2006 effects list: *one coin, taped to the tiller. (L3)* 2. Priya's tide work proves the skiff was driven, not drifted — and the last logbook entry is in the wrong hand. Murder. *(L4)* 3. Danny wasn't robbing the till — he *was* the till: the second ledger shows a fortune crossing every Thursday, and in his last month he starts underlining. Building a case. *(L7)* 4. The journalist Danny was building it for was Thomas Quinn. The meet never happened. *(L8→L9)* 5. The Thursday crossings never stopped. The Pier 13 drop is live *tonight. (L6, confirmed L10)* 6. The Ferryman leaves Ally an envelope: his coin, and a photocopy of her father's 2006 press badge. He has watched the Quinns for twenty years. *(L10)*

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## Lead table

| # | id      | Type      | Title                  | Gates           | Requirement theme                             | Band |
|---|---------|-----------|------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------|------|
| 1 | f2_tip  | Podcast   | The Caller on Line Two | (episode start) | forensic tools — setting up the interview rig | Easy |
| 2 | f2_rosa | Interview | The Fuel               | spawn           | diner food — 6                                | Easy |

| #  | id          | Type        | Title                             | Gates         | Requirement theme                                 | Band                                                        |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
|    |             |             | Dock                              | ed by L1      | a.m. coffee and pastries for Rosa                 |                                                             |
| 3  | f2_gazette  | Evidence    | What the Gazette Printed          | spawned by L1 | press items — Arthur's morgue files               | Standard                                                    |
| 4  | f2_tides    | Data        | Run the Tides                     | L2 + L3       | forensic tools — Priya's charts and light table   | Standard                                                    |
| 5  | f2_pod1     | Podcast     | Episode Update: The Man Who Rowed | L4            | press items — cutting the mid-season episode      | Standard (milestone: +200 CaseCash, +20 energy)             |
| 6  | f2_watchman | Interview   | The Man Who Locked the Gates      | spawned by L5 | diner food — a bus-stop meeting, two coffees      | Standard                                                    |
| 7  | f2_ledger   | Money Trail | The Second Ledger                 | spawned by L5 | garage tools — cutting open a taped tin box       | Hard                                                        |
| 8  | f2_gerald   | Discuss     | Gerald's Booth                    | spawned by L5 | harbour/bar items — the Rusty Anchor              | Standard                                                    |
| 9  | f2_badge    | Evidence    | The Gate Pass                     | L7 + L8       | fingerprint evidence — Thomas's lockbox papers    | Hard                                                        |
| 10 | f2_pier13   | Location    | Pier 13                           | L9 + L6       | harbour items — staking out the pylons            | Very Hard (+2 ingots)                                       |
| 11 | f2_delcruz  | Interview   | Make It Official                  | L10           | diner food — Del Cruz's lunch break               | Standard                                                    |
| 12 | f2_close    | Podcast     | The Ferryman, Part One            | L11           | press items — the episode that reopens a homicide | Very Hard (milestone: +500 CaseCash, +20 energy, +3 ingots) |

Card subtitles: 1. *A twenty-year-old voice on line two. "You say goodnight to the harbour. It kept my father in 2006."* 2. *Rosa Reyes kept her father's logbook through the smear and the silence. She's ready to open it.* 3. *The Reyes file closed in six days, and the Gazette helped bury him. Arthur Finch owes this one.* 4. *Water moves the way it moves, whoever signs the paperwork. Priya Shah checks the tides against the story.*

5. *Two weeks on the water. Time to tell Havenbay what the logbook says.* 6. *Eddie Okafor locked the harbour gates for thirty years. He'll talk — two suburbs from the water.* 7. *A tin box in Rosa's attic, taped shut in 2006. Danny kept a second book.* 8. *Gerald's booth at the Anchor. He remembers the Reyes closure — and whose diary mentions a Thursday meet.* 9. *Dad's lockbox holds a Pier 13 gate pass from October 2006. It was never used.* 10. *Thursday, 4:40 a.m., Pier 13. If the route still runs, it runs tonight.* 11. *A twenty-year-old homicide, a falsified file, a live operation. Del Cruz is listening.* 12. *Danny Reyes was not a thief. Say it on the record.*

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## Dialogue scripts

### L1 — f2\_tip · “The Caller on Line Two” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---|---------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Line two stayed lit for forty minutes before I picked it up. The voice on the other end was steady — the way people get when they've rehearsed something for twenty years.                              |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “You say goodnight to the harbour,” she said. “Every week, like it's a friend. It kept my father. Danny Reyes — he rowed the last crossing, and one night the boat came back without him.”              |
| 3 | Ally    | worried   | Accident, the file says. Closed in six days, with a rumour pinned to a dead man's coat: that he'd been skimming the till. His daughter kept his logbook. She says the last entry isn't his handwriting. |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral   | I've read a lot of last words. These were written by someone still breathing. This is Echoes of Havenbay. Episode two starts at the water. <i>(sets aq.lead.f2_tip.seen)</i>                            |

### L2 — f2\_rosa · “The Fuel Dock” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---|---------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | The Harbor Ward fuel dock at six a.m. smells like diesel and old rain. Rosa Reyes has run it since she was nineteen — since the week the harbour decided her father was a thief who fell in the dark. |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “He hated the water at night,” she told me. “Twenty years on the crossing and he never once swam. Ferryman don't fall, Miss Quinn. They get put over the side.”                                       |
| 3 | Ally    | worried   | She gave me the logbook. Eleven years of crossings, one line each — weather, cargo, initials. The last line has no weather and no initials, and the ink skips like the pen was moving too fast.       |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral   | Rosa kept this book through the smear, the silence, the sympathy casseroles. Twenty years is a long time to hold a door open. I intend to walk through it.                                            |

### L3 — f2\_gazette · “What the Gazette Printed” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---|---------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Arthur Finch keeps the Gazette’s memory in a basement he calls the morgue. He pulled the Reyes clippings before I finished asking. He’d been waiting for someone to ask for twenty years.                    |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “We ran the thief story,” he said, laying down a 2006 brief — four sentences, no byline, no source. “It arrived written. Editor called it a tip. I called it an obituary for a man’s name.”                  |
| 3 | Ally    | surprised | His copy of the police file holds something the official one doesn’t anymore: the effects list from the skiff. Rope, thermos, tackle box. And one item nobody explains — a single coin, taped to the tiller. |
| 4 | Ally    | worried   | Files this clean don’t happen by accident, and smears don’t write themselves. Somebody built this forgetting. They left two things behind: the tides, and the coin.                                          |

### L4 — f2\_tides · “Run the Tides” (3 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---|---------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Dr. Priya Shah spread the 2006 tide tables across her light table like an accusation. Here’s what a tide can’t do: lie. Water moves the way it moves, whoever signs the paperwork.              |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “The skiff was found circling under Kestrel Point,” she said. “On that night’s ebb, a drifting boat from his route ends up two miles south. This boat didn’t drift, Ally. It was driven there.” |
| 3 | Ally    | neutral   | And the last logbook line — “rough water, going out again” — leans like a right-handed man wrote it. Rosa’s father was left-handed. Somebody wrote Danny’s goodbye for him.                     |

### L5 — f2\_pod1 · “Episode Update: The Man Who Rowed” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---|---------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral | This is Echoes of Havenbay. Two weeks on the water. Here’s what we know.                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2 | Ally    | neutral | Danny Reyes rowed the harbour’s last crossing for eleven years, and one night in 2006 his boat came home without him. The file says accident. The tides say the boat was driven. The logbook says his last words belong to someone else’s hand. |
| 3 | Ally    | worried | “He kept a book,” his daughter told me. It turns out he kept two. More on that when I’m sure her attic isn’t being watched.                                                                                                                     |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral | Danny Reyes didn’t fall. And the man who wrote his                                                                                                                                                                                              |

| # | Speaker | Emotion | Line                                                                                                             |
|---|---------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |         |         | goodbye may have written more than one. Stay with me.<br>(narrative flag: f2.phase1.complete — fires on Proceed) |

#### L6 — f2\_watchman · “The Man Who Locked the Gates” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---|---------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Eddie Okafor locked the harbour gates every night for thirty years. He agreed to meet me at a bus stop two suburbs from the water. His choice. His route.                                                                                                               |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “Thursday nights the Pier 13 gate stayed open,” he said. “Merrick’s orders. Special crossing. No manifest, no lights — and you didn’t look at the skiff. You looked at your shoes.”                                                                                     |
| 3 | Ally    | worried   | Sailor Merrick. Dock foreman, 2001 to 2011. Died with a marina berth he couldn’t afford and a funeral nobody cried at. Eddie says Merrick took a boat out the night Danny vanished. He’s been afraid for twenty years — not of Merrick. Of whoever Merrick answered to. |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral   | “The Thursday crossings didn’t stop when Danny died,” he told me — at a bus stop, in daylight, still whispering. “They never stopped at all.” A friend of the show once counted quiet boats from her window in Rivermouth. They never stop anywhere.                    |

#### L7 — f2\_ledger · “The Second Ledger” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---|---------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Rosa’s attic. One tin box, taped shut in 2006 by a nineteen-year-old who didn’t know what she was saving. Inside: the second book.                                                                          |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | Same eleven years, different truth. Amounts, dates, and five names that aren’t names — Pilot, Chalk, Anchor, Ledger, and one that’s just F. Cash out from Pier 13 on Thursdays. Cash back at dawn, lighter. |
| 3 | Ally    | neutral   | Run the totals and this harbour moved more money in a year than the port authority declared in five. None of it ever touched a bank. All of it crossed dark water in a rowing boat.                         |
| 4 | Ally    | worried   | Danny wasn’t stealing from the till. Danny <i>was</i> the till. And in his final month the entries change — he starts underlining. He was building a case. The question is who he was building it for.      |

#### L8 — f2\_gerald · “Gerald’s Booth” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion | Line                                                                                                       |
|---|---------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Gerald  | worried | Mo kept the booth clear and the coffee coming — she remembers Danny, you know. I remember the closure. Six |

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---|---------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |         |           | days. The detective who signed it retired eighteen months later, boat and berth, the whole postcard. Nobody asks where a pension like that comes from. That's the point of it.                                |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | Gerald — Dad's 2006 diary. October. "D.R., last crossing, Thursday. He keeps a book." The meet never happened, did it. Danny disappeared four days before Thursday.                                           |
| 3 | Gerald  | sad       | Your father carried that one to the end, love. He decided his phone was the leak, and he never wrote a source's real name again. All those initials in his files — Danny Reyes taught him that. Posthumously. |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral   | Twenty years and two Quinns in the same ledger. Whoever they are, they've been part of this family longer than I have. Time they met me properly.                                                             |

### L9 — f2\_badge · "The Gate Pass" (3 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---|---------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Dad's lockbox again. I used to think it was a shrine. It's a filing cabinet with a guilt complex.                                                                                                                                                              |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | October 2006: a Pier 13 gate pass, visitor class, made out to T. Quinn. Never used. Under it, a note in his shorthand: "If D. doesn't show, the book goes to the water. Don't chase it. They count the ones who chase."                                        |
| 3 | Ally    | worried   | He stopped chasing — for two years, until another story wouldn't let him sleep. Season talk; tonight is Danny's. The gate pass names the drop, and the drop matches a line in the second ledger. If the Thursday crossings never stopped, neither did Pier 13. |

### L10 — f2\_pier13 · "Pier 13" (5 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---|---------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | worried   | Thursday, 4:40 a.m. Pier 13, north shed — where a gate pass from 2006 says my father should have stood. I brought a camera and Rosa's blessing. I have never felt less alone in an empty place.                       |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | At 5:02 a skiff crossed with no lights. One figure, one crate, gone in ninety seconds. Twenty years after Danny Reyes went into the water, his route still runs on his tide.                                          |
| 3 | Ally    | surprised | The crate wasn't cargo. It was left facing my hide, lid loose, one envelope inside. My name on it — not "A. Quinn." <i>Ally</i> . The way a friend would write it.                                                    |
| 4 | Ally    | worried   | Inside: a coin — the same coin they taped to Danny's tiller, the kind they find near these pylons when someone stops being a problem. Under it, a photocopy of my father's press badge, 2006. And five words in block |

| # | Speaker | Emotion | Line                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---|---------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |         |         | capitals: THE ROUTE OUTLIVES ITS RIDERS.                                                                                                                                |
| 5 | Ally    | angry   | You want me scared. Noted. But you photocopied my father — which means you kept the original. Twenty years of souvenirs, Ferryman. I'm coming for the whole collection. |

#### L11 — f2\_delcruz · “Make It Official” (4 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion   | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---|---------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral   | Sergeant Del Cruz met me on her lunch break, off the record — which is how all my favourite police work starts. Harbor Ward precinct. Her ward. Her water.                                                                           |
| 2 | Ally    | surprised | “You’re handing me a twenty-year-old homicide with a falsified file, a dead suspect, and a live operation,” she said. “You know what that does to a career?” I said I didn’t. She said, “Wakes it up. Mine’s been asleep for years.” |
| 3 | Ally    | worried   | She’ll walk Priya’s tide analysis and the handwriting into the cold case unit — officially anonymous, unofficially airtight. The live operation she can’t touch without a taskforce. Taskforces leak. We both know where.            |
| 4 | Ally    | neutral   | Rosa will get a phone call this week that’s twenty years late. It won’t say “murder” yet. It will say “reopened.” Some words weigh more in an ear that’s waited that long.                                                           |

#### L12 — f2\_close · “The Ferryman, Part One” (5 nodes)

| # | Speaker | Emotion | Line                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---|---------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Ally    | neutral | This is Echoes of Havenbay — and as of nine o’clock this morning, the Reyes crossing is a homicide investigation.                                                                                                          |
| 2 | Ally    | neutral | Danny Reyes was not a thief. Say it at the fuel dock. Say it at Mo’s. He carried other men’s money across dark water, and when he tried to put it down, the water was told to keep him.                                    |
| 3 | Ally    | sad     | Rosa listened to the whole episode standing up, holding the logbook. When it ended, she wrote one line beneath her father’s last one — in her own hand, with today’s date. Ledgers should end honestly. Now this one does. |
| 4 | Ally    | worried | The man who ordered that crossing is still out there, still counting. He left me his coin, and a message written in my father’s ghost. He believes the route outlives its riders.                                          |
| 5 | Ally    | neutral | Maybe it does. But hear this, Havenbay: routes need water, and the tide is turning. I’m Ally Quinn. Episode three is already recording. <i>(narrative flag: f2.ep02.complete — fires on Proceed)</i>                       |

## Season-arc notch

This episode converts the Ferryman from a name into a present, aware antagonist — and makes it generational: he watched Thomas, now he watches Ally, and he wants her to know. New season facts: the money route is older than any corporate name the season will meet (the Voss Bio thread lands ~Episode 5, unnamed on air until then) and moves physically by water from Pier 13 on a fixed tide; the operation uses code names (Pilot, Chalk, Anchor, Ledger, F); the coin calling card goes back at least to 2006; Thomas lost a source that year and changed his methods because of it. Deliberately unanswered: whether “F” is the Ferryman himself or his operator (a broker like Silas Vex fits the ledger’s handwriting-free discipline); what the crossings carry now; where the route lands; whether the Rivermouth quiet boats (Episode 1) and the Thursday crossings share water or masters — resonance planted at L6n4, the connection reserved for an explicit season decision; and — pointed at Episode 3 — why Del Cruz believes a taskforce would leak from inside Havenbay PD.

## The resolution beat

Rosa. Twenty years of holding a door open, resolved not by an arrest (her father’s killer is dead) but by the truth said out loud and the case reopened — sealed by the image of her writing the logbook’s final line herself, in her own hand, with the date. The ledger ends honestly. That’s the episode’s thesis in one physical action, and Ally never explains it.

## Canon usage note

**Canon used:** Pier 13 (the drop — its coin lore is the episode’s spine), the Ferryman’s coin (planted in the 2006 effects list, paid off in the envelope), Arthur Finch/the Gazette morgue (archives lead — and the smear ran in his own paper, giving him skin), Dr. Priya Shah (tide/handwriting forensics), Kestrel Point (where the skiff was found), the Rusty Anchor + Mo Callahan (Gerald’s booth), Sgt. Del Cruz/Harbor Ward (reopening), Thomas Quinn’s lockbox/shorthand/source discipline, the ~Ep5 Voss Bio thread (production note only — L9n3 keeps it unnamed on air), Silas Vex (named as a season hypothesis only). **Invented (episode-level only):** Danny and Rosa Reyes (victim and keeper — no canon role exists), Eddie Okafor (one-off witness), Sailor Merrick (dead hand of the crime). Each fills a role canon deliberately leaves open per episode.

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## v3 changes (2026-07-12 — season-order re-points, per bible Ch 6.2)

| Item                 | Resolution                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 · L1 caller opener | “You found the ghost student” replaced with The Listener’s goodnight-harbour ritual (L1n2 + card subtitle 1) — the caller trusts the show because it listens, not because of a named prior case. |
| 2 · Voss Bio         | Unnamed in dialogue (L9n3 generalized to “another story wouldn’t let him sleep”); survives as a production note; the thread lands                                                                |

| Item                     | Resolution                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                          | ~Ep5 (Ghost Student).                                                                                                                                                            |
| 3 · Aired-so-far audit   | No other on-air references to prior episodes found; logline, reveal ladder, and remaining scripts untouched.                                                                     |
| 4 · Rivermouth resonance | One light connective line added at L6n4 (a friend of the show, quiet boats, her window). Villain identity deliberately NOT connected — reserved for an explicit season decision. |

Remaining before lock: table read (performance/timing veto) → numbered-revision passes as needed → VO LOCK; cue sheet and actor sides generate from asset data at production.